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US equities tumble as yields rise, VIX spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The major US indices closed sharply lower on Tuesday, with the **S&P 500** down -1.09% to 7,659.44 and the **Nasdaq 100** off -2.50% at 29,187.55. The market sell-off was driven by a jump in the 10-year Treasury yield to 5.10% and a 21.45% surge in the VIX to 19.99, underscoring heightened risk aversion.

Energy led the rally, with the **XLE** ETF up +2.52%, while technology lagged sharply; **NVDA** fell -1.43% and **MSFT** slipped -1.93%. Investors will watch upcoming earnings from **AAPL** and **JPM** for clues on earnings momentum.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,659.44	-1.09%	
Dow Jones	52,002.41	-0.34%	
Nasdaq 100	29,187.55	-2.50%	
Russell 2000	2,721.37	-1.66%	
VIX	19.99	+21.45%	Risk gauge
10Y Yield	5.10%	+0.18%	Highest since 2023
WTI Crude	97.41	-3.94%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
JPM	339.72	+1.25%
AVGO	328.75	-4.52%
META	709.33	-3.72%
GS	881.26	-1.12%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Event	US CPI (Oct) released 02:30 HKT
YoY inflation	3.2% (down 0.1 pts)
Core CPI	3.5% (steady)

The October CPI came in at 3.2% YoY, a slight dip that kept the Fed’s tightening narrative alive. Core CPI held at 3.5%, reinforcing expectations of a higher-for-longer policy stance.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%–5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.10%, up +0.18%
- Key data releases: US CPI 02:30 HKT, Retail Sales 04:00 HKT, Existing-home sales 06:30 HKT

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated after the latest airstrike, pressuring oil markets.
- China’s manufacturing PMI (09:00 HKT) expected to show contraction, adding to global growth concerns.
- Eurozone inflation data due Friday could influence DXY, currently at 101.83.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Oct 22	`AAPL`	Revenue beat, iPhone demand trend
10:00 Oct 22	`JPM`	Net interest income margin
11:00 Oct 22	`XOM`	Impact of oil price swing on upstream earnings
13:30 Oct 22	`NVDA`	AI chip inventory levels

Stocks worth watching

- `AAPL` – strong services revenue could offset iPhone softness.
- `JPM` – higher rates may boost net interest margin.
- `XLE` – energy rally on supply concerns; price-sensitive.
- `NVDA` – AI demand remains robust but inventory risk rising.
- `META` – ad spend recovery uncertain after earnings miss.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further rise in 10-year yield above `5.20%`.
- Escalation of Middle-East conflict pushing oil above `110` USD.
- Weak CPI surprise indicating deeper inflationary pressure.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected earnings from `AAPL` or `JPM`.
- Gold rally breaching `4,300` USD, signaling safe-haven flow.
- VIX pull-back below 15, indicating risk appetite return.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

FRED — 10-Year Treasury Yield

CME Group — WTI Crude

SEC — Company Filings